

Saturday, 30 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

28° 18°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

25° 13°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

24° 14°

GLASGOW

Light rain

17° 11°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Keir Starmer has been defending Labour's policy decisions this week, responding to recent comments from former Prime Minister Sir Tony Blair.

Sir Tony had suggested the current government lacks a "coherent plan" for the country. Starmer's remarks come as he continues to shape Labour's agenda.

POLITICS · UK

2

A man accused of selling toxic chemicals online to people worldwide has admitted charges related to aiding suicides.

Kenneth Law pleaded guilty in Canada to offences involving Canadian victims. However, families in the UK are pushing for charges here, linking him to 79 deaths in Britain.

CRIME · UK

3

A surgeon, Neil Hopper, has been struck off the medical register after being deemed an extreme risk to public safety.

The decision means Mr Hopper, an amputee surgeon, can no longer practice. This follows an assessment that highlighted significant concerns for patient protection.

HEALTH · UK

What's coming up

1

Natalie Imbruglia is looking forward to sharing the stage with Sir Tom Jones at an upcoming concert.

The Australian singer will be a support act for the Welsh icon. She'll be joined by Nathan Evans and Saint Phnx for the highly anticipated event.

MUSIC · UPCOMING

2

Dame Mary Berry has been sharing her passion for gardening and confirming she has no plans to step away from her career.

The much-loved TV cook offered some green-fingered tips for listeners. She also encouraged young people to work hard and pursue their ambitions.

TV · ONGOING

3

The British Museum has decided to postpone a planned Jewish Culture Month event due to concerns about potential protests.

This decision follows advice about anticipated demonstrations. The Campaign Against Antisemitism called the postponement a "victory" for what they termed an "antisemitic mob."

CULTURE · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1

British runner Keely Hodgkinson is aiming for a new world record in the 800m at the London Diamond League this July.

She's expressed her ambition to break the long-standing record on home soil. It promises to be an exciting "battle of world records" for athletics fans.

ATHLETICS · UK

2

Former Sunderland footballer Roly Gregoire is finally setting the record straight about his career after 46 years.

After suffering a knee injury in 1980, he quit football due to the racism he endured. Gregoire found it so difficult he couldn't watch the sport for many years.

FOOTBALL · UK

3

Real Madrid has been named the most valuable football club globally, with Barcelona now in second place.

The Spanish giants top the list in terms of financial valuation. Interestingly, Barcelona has now overtaken Manchester United, pushing the English club down to third.

FOOTBALL · GLOBAL

Quick hits

- 1 The fastest-growing hobby of 2026 is hand-embroidery — sales of needles and thread up 180% in a year.**
Crafters say it's the perfect 'phone detox' — slow, tactile, satisfying. TikTok is full of 20-somethings showing off custom denim jackets.
- 2 Roses are out, peonies are in — UK florists report a 200% rise in peony orders for weddings this summer.**
Brides cite 'softer, less staged' aesthetics. Wholesale peony prices have crept up accordingly.
- 3 62% of us have lied about reading a book to look smart in front of someone we fancy.**
Most-faked titles: 1984, Pride and Prejudice and (awkwardly) the Bible. One in five admit to faking a whole dinner-party conversation about a novel they'd only seen the cover of.
- 4 Half of UK adults can't name a single member of the cabinet — but 80% can name three Love Island contestants.**
Political engagement researchers say it's not apathy so much as 'noise overload'. People remember faces from things they actively watch.
- 5 Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.**
Top topics: 'what we're doing later', 'what we just saw out the window' and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human.
- 6 Pubs report a Tuesday boom — the new 'mid-week meet' is the fastest-growing dining occasion.**
Operators say WFH-ers like getting out the house mid-week without the weekend crowds. Tuesday wine sales are up almost 30%.
- 7 Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**
Prices have nearly doubled in two years. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles, others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 57% of UK workers admit doing THIS while on a work call. What?

ANSWER: GOING TO THE LOO.

Q Asked what makes them feel old, the top answer wasn't grey hairs — it was THIS. What?

ANSWER: NOT RECOGNISING ANY OF THE NAMES AT THE TOP OF THE CHARTS.

TALK TOPIC

- **A new study says we form a strong opinion of someone within 7 seconds of meeting them.**
Talk-back: what's the quickest you've ever decided you didn't like someone — and were you right? Or the quickest you DID like someone?
- **Matching pet-and-owner outfits are apparently making a comeback this summer.**
Would you actually do it? And if so — does the dog get a vote in the wardrobe?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **UK News.** A Yorkshire farmer has won a planning row by getting his prize-winning sheep listed as 'agricultural heritage', preventing a housing development from going ahead next to his field.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Cornish café has started charging customers extra if they ask for the WiFi password before placing their order, claiming it 'improves table turnover by 40%'.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The plastic bits on the ends of shoelaces are called aglets.
- Penguins propose to their mates by giving them a pebble.
- Strawberries aren't actually berries, but bananas, watermelons and pumpkins are.
- Cats have a special collarbone that lets them always land on their feet — usually.
- The word 'set' has the most definitions of any word in the English language — 430.
- The longest English word without a vowel is 'rhythms'.
- Ketchup was sold in the 1830s as medicine.
- Hippos secrete their own natural sunscreen — a reddish, oily substance.

On this day

Day 150 of the year, 215 days left in 2026. Today Anguilla Day, commemorates the beginning of the Anguillian Revolution in 1967. (Anguilla); Canary Islands Day (Spain); Christian feast day: Basil the Elder and Emmelia of Caesarea; Christian feast day: Dymphna. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1975 — Andy Farrell, English rugby player and coach
- 1971 — Duncan Jones, English director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1966 — Stephen Malkmus, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1927 — Clint Walker, American actor and singer (died 2018)
- 1935 — Ruta Lee, Canadian-American actress and dancer
- 1997 — Jake Short, American actor
- 1964 — Tom Morello, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actor
- 1944 — Meredith MacRae, American actress (died 2000)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1989 — Tiananmen Square protests of 1989: The 10-metre high "Goddess of Democracy" statue is unveiled in Tiananmen Square by student demonstrators.
- 1966 — Former Congolese Prime Minister, Évariste Kimba, and several other politicians are publicly executed in Kinshasa on the orders of President Joseph Mobutu.
- 1998 — The 6.5 Mw Afghanistan earthquake shook the Takhar Province of northern Afghanistan with a maximum Mercalli intensity of VII (Very strong), killing around 4,000–4,500.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2003 — Depayin massacre: At least 70 people associated with the National League for Democracy are killed by government-sponsored mob in Burma. Aung San Suu Kyi flees the scene, but is arrested soon afterwards.
- 1972 — In Ben Gurion Airport (at the time: Lod Airport), Israel, members of the Japanese Red Army carry out the Lod Airport massacre, killing 24 people and injuring 78 others.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1990 — Croatian Parliament is constituted after the first free, multi-party elections, today celebrated as the National Day of Croatia.

- 2013 — Nigeria passes a law banning same-sex marriage.
- 1967 — The Nigerian Eastern Region declares independence as the Republic of Biafra, sparking a civil war.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 151 of the year, 214 days left in 2026. Today Anniversary of Royal Brunei Malay Regiment (Brunei); Christian feast day: Blessed Camilla Battista da Varano; Christian feast day: Cantius, Cantianus, and Cantianilla; Christian feast day: Hermias. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1938 — Peter Yarrow, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer (died 2025)
- 1972 — Archie Panjabi, British actress
- 1954 — Vicki Sue Robinson, American actress and singer (died 2000)
- 1991 — Azealia Banks, American singer-songwriter and rapper
- 1956 — John Young, English singer-songwriter and keyboard player
- 1930 — Clint Eastwood, American actor, director, musician, and producer
- 1938 — Johnny Paycheck, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2003)
- 1963 — Wesley Willis, American singer-songwriter and keyboard player (died 2003)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2013 — The asteroid 1998 QE2 and its moon make their closest approach to Earth for the next two centuries.
- 1973 — The United States Senate votes to cut off funding for the bombing of Khmer Rouge targets within Cambodia, hastening the end of the Cambodian Civil War.
- 2005 — Vanity Fair reveals that Mark Felt was "Deep Throat".

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2010 — Israeli Shayetet 13 commandos boarded the Gaza Freedom Flotilla while still in international waters trying to break the ongoing blockade of the Gaza Strip; nine Turkish citizens on the flotilla were killed in the ensuing violent affray.
- 1961 — In Moscow City Court, the Rokotov–Faibishenko show trial begins, despite the Khrushchev Thaw to reverse Stalinist elements in Soviet society.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026		AUGUST 2026	
FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License	FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)	FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
JUNE 2026		FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad	FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)	SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5	FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life	FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
JULY 2026		FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
WED 1	Minions & Monsters	FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington	OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn	FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off	FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU		
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day		

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		